offering lower grades in its neighbourhood, including anganwadis, in a radius of 5–10 km. This is to address the concern of thinly spread teaching and infrastructural resources by creating an educational complex with shared resources. A government survey in 2016 found that 28 per cent of India's public primary schools and 15 per cent of upper primary schools had less than thirty students. On the other hand, over 1 lakh schools were single-teacher schools. The creation of school complexes/clusters will be able to address these deficiencies.

NEP-2020 also proposes creation of a State School Standards Authority (SSSA) to 'establish a minimal set of standards based on basic parameters (namely, safety, security, basic infrastructure, number of teachers across subjects and grades, financial probity and sound processes of governance)'. NEP-2020 directs every state to establish 'an independent, state-wide, body' (SSSA).

The goal of policy and regulatory arrangements like SSSA is to assess and accredit all 'public and private schools (except the schools that are managed/aided/controlled by the Central government on the same criteria, benchmarks, and processes'. The objective is to hold all educational institutions 'to similar standards of audit and disclosure as a "not-for-profit" entity'.

NEP-2020 also proposes to create 'a higher educational system consisting of large, multidisciplinary universities and colleges, with at least one in or near every district, and with more HEIs [higher educational institutions] across India that offer medium of instruction or programmes in local/Indian languages'. HEIs include universities, autonomous colleges and other similar institutions. The Policy looks unfavourably at specialized HEIs that focus on a single or a few disciplines and makes no bones about its objective of phasing out 'single-stream HEIs'. The 'main thrust' of NEP-2020 'is to end the fragmentation of higher education by transforming higher education institutions into large multidisciplinary universities,